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MIAMI MAGIC FOR McLAREN

With his latest win coming at the Miami Grand Prix, Oscar Piastri is starting to **assert** himself as McLaren's championship leader.

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The Miami Grand Prix continues to be a special chapter in McLaren's story. In 2024, it was the site of Lando Norris' long-awaited maiden Formula One win, an important moment in the timeline that sparked a monumental journey for the eventual constructors' champion.

Fast-forward to 2025, McLaren arrived in Miami as the team to beat and lived up to that billing with wins in both the sprint and main race.

For 25-year-old Norris, it was a strong feeling of déjà vu as a timely Safety Car helped the British driver retain his lead and cross the finish line for the sprint race win. The spell of good fortune passed on to Oscar Piastri (**left**) in the main event.

The Australian claimed his third Grand Prix win in a row on Sunday, further extending his lead in the drivers' championship and pulling away from Norris.

Early success for Antonelli

Just when there was a hint of monotony starting to develop in the results, Mercedes' Kimi Andrea Antonelli (**right**) decided to shake things up by becoming the youngest-ever pole-sitter in the sport's history.

With a mighty final lap in the sprint qualifying session on Friday, Antonelli, at 18 years and 250 days, eclipsed Sebastian Vettel's long-standing record (21 years and 72 days), a tag the four-time champion had secured in 2008 when Antonelli was only two.

The young Italian, who was brought in to take Lewis Hamilton's place at Mercedes, has undoubtedly been the most impressive of the six rookies this season. Apart from one non-scoring race in Bahrain, he has not finished lower than sixth.

That he was taking over from a seven-time champion meant a lot of early attention and expectations regarding why the team picked him, but the teenager was quick to prove himself.